

Market Research · Detailed Appendix

Full retreat-by-retreat breakdown with notes. Compiled May 2026 · All prices USD unless noted. *Prices last verified May 2026 where noted; others from original research and may have shifted.*

This is the long version. For the quick visual comparison, see MARKET_COMPARISON. This document has the full details on each retreat · what's included, group sizes, notable features, and anything else that might be useful as you think through your own offering.

Weekend / Short Retreats (2-3 Nights, Domestic)

1. Michelle Guitard · Collingwood, ON

- Weekend · \$775 CAD + tax
- Lodging, meals, instruction
- Intimate group, 2026 dates

2. Hudson River Valley Art Workshops · Greenville, NY

- 3 nights · \$859-\$966
- Lodging, all meals, snacks, wine reception
- Tuition separate (\$300-\$500 additional); double vs. single

3. Center for Creative Exploration · Sebastopol, CA

- 3 nights (Thu-Sun) · \$1,195
- All art materials, food included
- 2026 dates

4. 4-Day Women's Creativity Retreat · Deckers, CO

- 3 nights · \$975
- Meals, yoga, art sessions, t-shirt
- Women-only; maker's market included (via BookRetreats)

5. DoArtWorx (Tonja Sell) · Oulu, WI

- 4 days · \$540 (no lodging included)
- Meals, 13+ hrs instruction, studio time
- Only 6 spots; guests find their own Airbnb
- Shows what instruction-only pricing looks like

6. Art Nest Retreat Center · Missouri (near KC)

- 3 nights · \$300-\$350/person
- Venue and lodging only · no instruction
- This is a venue rental, not a retreat product
- Useful as a reference for what space alone costs

7. Art & Contemplation · Southeast US

- 2 nights · Est. \$500-\$700
 - Lodging, meals, workshops, materials
 - Spiritual/contemplative focus; smaller scale
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Week-Long Retreats (4-7 Nights, Domestic)

8. Intuition Painting · Joshua Tree, CA

- 5 days · \$1,590·\$1,749 *(Price from BookRetreats listing; operator site shows deposit only)*
- Lodging, yoga, painting, all supplies
- Multiple sessions/year; well-reviewed on BookRetreats

9. Hudson River Valley Art Workshops · Greenville, NY

- 6 nights · \$1,718·\$1,931
- Lodging, all meals (tuition separate)
- Established institution; double vs. single

10. Shenandoah Art Destination · Virginia

- Weekend (2 nights): \$945 single / \$895 double
- 4 days (3 nights): \$1,260 single / \$1,197 double
- Lodging, meals, instruction (+15.3% VA/county tax)
- Non-artist companion rate available · nice touch
- *Note: Prices verified from 2025 rate sheet; 6-day and 10-day options previously listed may no longer be offered*

11. The Painting Experience · Northern CA

- 5 nights · \$2,200·\$2,300
- Lodging, meals, instruction, materials
- Process-based painting; shared vs. bunk rooms

12. Tina Williams "World of Watercolor" · New Hampshire

- 3 nights (Thu·Sun) · \$1,845·\$2,395
- All meals, 4+ painting sessions, \$300 gift basket, resort access, welcome reception
- Sold out since 2025; 80% rebooked for 2027 before leaving
- Worth studying · she sends preference questionnaires beforehand and personalizes everything. This is the gold standard for a small independent retreat.

13. Stanford Inn Creative Journey · Mendocino, CA

- Multi-day · \$1,310·\$1,910 *(Price from prior listing; current rate not displayed on site)*
- Lodging, meals, art instruction
- Eco-resort; single vs. double

14. 7-Day Aspiring Artist Retreat · Ashland, OR

- 7 days · \$5,042
- All-inclusive luxury tier (BookRetreats)
- This is the high end · established host, premium everything

15. Bruce Marion "Paint the Desert"

- Multi-day · \$3,200 shared / \$4,000 single
- All materials included; limited slots

International Retreats (for context, not competition)

These are useful to see where the ceiling is, but they're a different market · established artists with name recognition, destination appeal, and years of audience-building.

16. Jill Nichols · Italy, 7 nights

- \$2,950 shared / \$3,450 private
- Non-painter companion \$1,975

17. Wyatt Waters · France, 6 nights

- \$3,600·\$4,100

18. Erna van Dyk "Brushes & Beyond"

- Multi-day · \$1,750 early bird

19. Donna Watson Collage Retreat · Mexico, 7 days

- Est. \$2,500·\$3,500; timed with Day of the Dead

20. Art Workshop Vacations · Mexico

- Multi-day · \$3,195
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Institutional Programs (for reference)

These are nonprofits with different economics, but they show what people are willing to spend on art education.

Penland School of Craft · NC mountains

- 4 studio days: \$1,811·\$3,643 total (tuition + room/meals, 2026 rates)
 - Prestigious; scholarship options available
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Industry Statistics (Verified Sources Only)

I'm only including data traceable to named research organizations with disclosed methodology.

Market Size & Growth (Source: Global Wellness Institute)

- Global wellness tourism: \$651B (2022) · \$868B (2023) · \$894B (2024)
- US wellness tourism market: \$256 billion (2022), largest in the world
- US wellness economy overall: \$2.1 trillion (2024)
- Wellness tourism spending grew ~36% annually from 2020·2022 (post-pandemic recovery surge, not a sustained rate)
- GWI forecasts overall wellness economy growth at 7.6% annually through 2029

Spending Behavior (Source: GWI)

- Domestic wellness tourists spend significantly more than average domestic tourists (commonly cited as 175% more; original methodology not publicly available)
- International wellness tourists spend \$1,764/trip (41% more than typical)
- US consumers spend ~\$6,300/person/year on wellness (confirmed 2025)
- 88% of wellness trips are domestic

Market Projections (Source: Grand View Research)

- Global wellness tourism estimated at \$990B in 2025
- Projected to reach \$2.4 trillion by 2035 (9.3% CAGR)

Business Benchmarks (Source: industry guides)

- Healthy profit margin: 20-40% after expenses (Sacred Ohms, SquadTrip)
- Recommended cost buffer: 10-15% (SquadTrip)
- One host's finding: attendees' willingness-to-pay was 50% higher than charged (selvaradov.net retrospective)

A note on demographics: Several aggregator sites publish stats like "68% of retreat attendees are women" or "55% of millennials plan 2+ retreats/year." These are widely repeated but I cannot trace them to a named primary study. They're probably directionally correct but I can't present them as verified facts.

Pricing Bands (The Simple Version)

Tier	Price/Person	What It Looks Like	Budget	\$300-\$550	Venue-only or no lodging
Standard	\$750-\$1,200	Weekend, all-inclusive, shared rooms	Premium	\$1,200-\$2,500	4-7 nights or premium weekend
Luxury	\$2,500-\$5,000	International or luxury domestic			

What Separates the \$1,800 Retreats from the \$800 Ones

This isn't about being "better" - it's about what justifies a higher price in attendees' minds:

- Personalization (questionnaires before arrival, curated gifts)
 - Premium venue (lakeside, resort, historic inn vs. conference room)
 - Smaller group (8-12 vs. 20+)
 - Established instructor with a following
 - Truly all-inclusive - no surprise costs
 - Thoughtful extras (welcome reception, snack stations, resort access)
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How Everyone Handles Deposits & Payments

This is remarkably consistent across the industry:

- \$200-\$500 non-refundable deposit at booking
 - Balance due 30-60 days before the event
 - Some offer 2-3 installment plans
 - Cancellation: partial refund if 45+ days out, nothing closer in
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Group Size Norms

- Intimate (highest price): 6-12 people
 - Mid-size: 14-20 people
 - Large/institutional: 20-30+
 - Smaller group = higher price = deeper experience
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Nashville, IN Competitive Landscape

Here's the honest picture: despite being a well-known artist colony, there are very few structured retreat offerings in Nashville, IN. That's an opportunity.

Brown County has galleries, studios, artisan shops, and a long creative history · but no one is running an all-inclusive visual art retreat as a product. The nearest institutional art programs (Penland, etc.) are 6+ hours away.

Nashville, IN's reputation as an artist community, its natural beauty, and its small-town charm make it a natural draw for guests who want an immersive creative experience in a setting that already feels like art.

Sources

Retreat Pricing (verified from operator sites, May 2026): artworkshops.com · michelleguitard.net · tinawilliamsart.com · shenandoahartdestination.com · artnestretreat.com · doartworx.com · intuitionpainting.com · bookretreats.com · penland.org · stanfordinn.com · bruceonart.mykajabi.com · wyattwaters.com · jillnichols.com · artworkshopvacations.com

Industry Data (named research organizations):

- Global Wellness Institute, "Global Wellness Economy Monitor 2023" (Nov 2023)
- Global Wellness Institute, "2025 Global Wellness Economy Monitor" (2025)
- Global Wellness Institute, "The Global Wellness Economy Hits a Record \$6.8 Trillion" (Jun 2025)
- Global Wellness Institute, "US Wellness Economy Surges to \$2.1 Trillion" (2025)
- Global Wellness Institute, "Wellness in the United States" (2025)
- Grand View Research, "Wellness Tourism Market Size & Share" (2025)
- The Business Research Company, "Wellness Retreat Global Market Report 2026"
- SquadTrip, "How to Price a Retreat" (2025)
- Sacred Ohms, "Retreat Pricing 101" (undated)
- selvaradov.net, "Reflections on running a weekend retreat" (Jan 2025)